

Website proposal

An outdoor community brand with the confidence of a clothing label. Take norda's spacious photography, the menu approach you liked in Bandit, and Deus's personality - then give Pancake Boys its own simpler structure.

The first impression

Open on a mountain photograph or a short, quietly looping film: morning light, people gathering, batter hitting the griddle. It should feel like stepping into one of the hikes.

Place a large **PANCAKE BOYS** wordmark over the image, with a small line underneath: *Good hikes. Free pancakes. Come hungry.*

One clear button: **Join the next hike.** The opening should have room to breathe. Its job is to make someone feel the experience and want to come.

The visual identity

Use warm off-white, charcoal, and apron brown. Let the landscapes and people provide most of the color.

Pair bold, condensed headlines with a simple, readable font for details. Headlines can be oversized; body copy should stay short and conversational. Strong spacing, deliberate cropping, and a few thin dividing lines should carry the layout.

Use your actual photographs throughout: the aprons, red mixing bowl, pancakes on rocks, and friends eating together. Mix sweeping scenery with small, imperfect moments. That specificity is what will make the site feel like yours.

The navigation

Keep the header minimal: a small wordmark on the left and a hamburger menu on the right. The menu opens into a full-screen panel with large links: Next hike, Our story, Field notes, Merch, and Support the pancakes.

Include Instagram and contact information more quietly at the bottom. On mobile, the same structure should feel natural, with large tap targets.

The homepage

Build it as a sequence with its own rhythm:

- 1. The opening image or film.** Brand name, a short invitation, and the next-hike button.
- 2. The next hike.** A straightforward announcement showing the date, meeting time, trailhead, distance, elevation gain, difficulty, and what to bring. Clearly state that pancakes are free.
- 3. The story.** A short version of how a questionable mountain business idea became something people showed up for. Pair it with a photo of you and Conor.
- 4. Life on the trail.** A small selection of photographs, with different sizes and generous space. People should be as prominent as pancakes.
- 5. Keep the pancakes coming.** A brief explanation of how merch, contributions, and partners help make the hikes happen.
- 6. The footer.** A bold closing invitation, Instagram, contact, and essential links.

Merch belongs in the experience, but the homepage should lead with getting people outside together.

How it functions

The next-hike page becomes the reliable source for event details. Give visitors directions, a packing list, and a simple way to indicate they're coming so you can estimate pancake quantities. Display changes or cancellations prominently.

Past hikes become "Field notes": a few photos, the location, and a short memory. These can grow from material you already capture without creating another publishing obligation.

Merch gets a dedicated shop when products are ready. Support gets a simple contribution option and a partnership inquiry form. Explain what funding supports in plain language.

Updating a hike should mean editing one event entry. When no hike is scheduled, show an honest "Next hike coming soon" message and a way to follow announcements.

Make it feel like yours.

What makes it feel deliberately designed

Avoid repeated grids of rounded cards, generic icons, gradients, floating badges, and decorative statistics. Give each section a layout suited to its content.

Use motion sparingly: a smooth menu transition, subtle image reveals, and restrained hover effects. Scrolling should stay familiar and fast.

Keep the writing recognizably yours. "We carried a griddle up a mountain" has more character than a polished paragraph about adventure and connection.

The result

A site that feels spacious, bold, and a little unconventional - with enough polish to support merch and partnerships, and enough warmth that a stranger feels invited to the next hike.

Reference direction

norda: spacious photography and an immersive outdoor opening.

Bandit: the menu approach and a community feeling.

Deus Ex Machina: personality and cultural confidence, with a simpler layout.

Gozney: admired, but avoid the polished generic treatment that felt too close to an AI-built site.